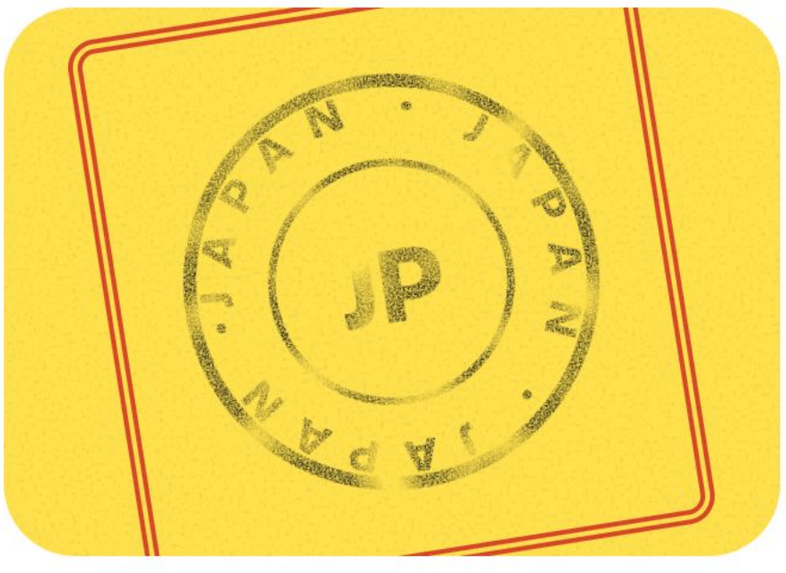
Japanese typesetting rules designers miss





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The rules that matter

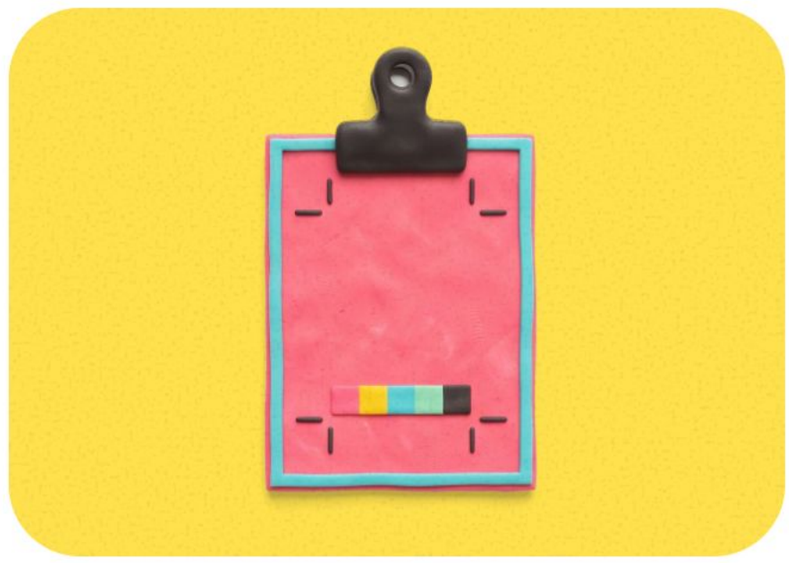


Rule	What it means
禁則処理	Some characters can’t start or end a line
約物	Punctuation takes a full character cell
縦書き	Vertical, top to bottom, right to left
ルビ	Reading guides beside rare kanji

Source: W3C Requirements for Japanese Text Layout

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Mixed scripts



Four scripts

Kanji, hiragana, katakana, Latin

Latin

A matched face, often slightly larger

Line length

Around 30 to 40 characters

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Turn on kinsoku

Many layout tools need Japanese line breaking switched on.

Otherwise lines start with 。 or split words.

Line ends with 。

Line starts with 、



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In Japan, good typesetting is invisible. Bad typesetting isn't.

Taking a Western brand into Japan, Korea or wider APAC?

Give me a shout

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